

Whitney Zilton

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SUMMARY

Backend Software Engineer with experience building distributed systems, event-driven services, and high-traffic APIs. Skilled in Go and Python, with experience designing microservices, Kafka-based architectures, and automation tooling for enterprise platforms. Passionate about building reliable, observable systems and applying secure SDLC practices to deliver resilient software.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer, Target

October 2023 - October 2025

- Implemented automation tooling to streamline application deployment on Target Application Platform, including cluster and secrets configuration enhancements and JaCoCo CI/CD integration.
- Improved scalability and reliability of high-traffic backend APIs through autoscaling design, performance testing, and observability enhancements in Grafana.
- Developed Kafka-based services and libraries in Kotlin to enrich event streams with product metadata, supporting downstream analytics and personalization.
- Advanced secure SDLC practices through threat modeling, penetration testing coordination, and vulnerability remediation across SCA, SAST, and DAST tooling.

Software Engineer, Target

May 2021 - October 2023

- Automated configuration-change approvals via Slackbot, reducing response times from 3 hours to under 2 minutes and lowering operational load.
- Developed a Kafka integration library in Go to standardize producer and consumer communication patterns across backend microservices.
- Implemented Kafka consumer logic in Go microservices to automate LDAP/Active Directory group-based access provisioning across multiple internal systems.
- Facilitated onboarding for 40+ engineers in the July 2021 Early Tech Talent cohort through cohort programming, presentations, and pod support.

Associate Software Engineer, Target

April 2020 - May 2021

- Developed backend endpoints in Python to automate Ansible AWX workflows for network resource provisioning, reducing manual configuration time by 60 minutes per API call.
- Created a backend event service in Go enabling event creation across multiple network resource types.
- Implemented a Go microservice to configure WAN backup routers, supporting business continuity during network outages.
- Served as Pod Coach Lead for the January 2021 Early Tech Talent cohort, supporting 50+ engineers through pod check-ins, technical guidance, and escalation of onboarding challenges.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

Oregon State University

Bachelor of Arts in American Studies

Macalester College

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Golang (Go), Kotlin, JavaScript, Groovy

Backend Development: REST APIs, GraphQL APIs, Microservices, Event-Driven Architectures

Frameworks: Micronaut, Flask, Django

Messaging & Data Systems: Kafka, PostgreSQL, MongoDB

Infrastructure & DevOps: Docker, Git, GitHub, CI/CD Pipelines

Security: Threat Modeling, Secure SDLC, SAST / DAST / SCA Integration

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY

Engagement Coordinator, WiCyS Houston Affiliate — January 2026 to Present

Organizer, Cybersecurity Circle (Sugar Land Chapter) — leads monthly cybersecurity sessions, March 2026 to Present